TOWN OF THUNDERBOLT
REGULAR MONTHLY MEETING
WEDNESDAY, JULY 10, 2024
6:00 PM

AGENDA HEARING

Public has five minutes per person to ask questions or comment on any agenda item.
Mayor Williams opened the public hearing up at 6 pm.

Mayor Williams asked Interim Town Administrator Matthew Walker to explain the Planning & Zoning application before Council this evening. Mr. Walker explained the request was to add a water tap to the property in order to provide water to wash equipment, dumpsters, and to water plants that the applicant wished to plant along the front side of the property. Mr. Walker stated the request was recommended for approval with the conditions adding a catch-basin or other items to catch the water being used. The concern is the contaminated water will run off into the ditches, which is not permissible.

Council Member Lavin asked Director Crosby about the potential water usage by the applicant. Director Crosby estimated between 5,000-15,000 gallons per month. Council Member Crenshaw mentioned the Abercorn Creek withdrawal and asked if we owed the City of Savannah for any water usage. Council Member Lavin noted that more usage will cost the Town more. Council Member Drohan stated it is 2.8 times higher cost to buy water rather than produce water. Dr. Drohan stated we need to think about the future and asked if we will ever be able to drill another well in future.

Sue DeRosa, 3215 Bannon Dr, stated she taught environmental science and there are ways to reduce water usage. She stated shallow wells are not a way to think about conserving and reducing water usage. She also stated that water from roofs, A/Cs, and car washes can be caught in a cistern and recycled.

Joan Hayes, 2801 Hayes Ave, spoke about the condition of Shell Rd between Martha and Whatley. She stated it is terrible and wants to know what can be done about it.

Meredith Allen, 3220 Falligant Ave, stated that houses being converted to STRs impacts the feeling of community. She stated it is new people all the time and it impacts all neighbors. She would like the Town to look into creating zones where STRs are allowed.

Jan Yarbrough, 24 Bonaventure Rd, asked the Town to re-look at the P&Z request and possibly approve with a limit on the water usage allowed.

Joan Dickerson, 3204 Gragg St, asked about the Shell Rd STRs (Ashlyn Retreat). Interim Town Administrator stated the property owner has had STR Certificates for these houses since before the cap of 70 was reached. The houses are now complete and the homes are now being rented as STR properties.

Beth Ferencsik, 18 Bonaventure Rd, mention the blind curves on Bonaventure Rd. and stated stop signs are needed.

Catherine Clements, 3224 Cedar St, mentioned there are 2 STR units on her street. She stated there are sometimes up to 8 cars in driveways/yards. She stated she called and complained, and that she didn't know who was staying there or how many people. She also stated she was almost hit on Whatley near Wright Ave.

Mayor Williams closed the public comment at 6:37 pm.

REGULAR MEETING

1. **Call to order -** Mayor Williams called the meeting to order at 6:38 pm.

2. **Roll Call by Presiding Officer with Invocation, followed by the Pledge of Allegiance**

   In Attendance is Mayor Dana Williams and Council Members: Bethany Skipper-Greer, David Crenshaw, Edward Drohan, James Lavin, and Brooks Barbaree. Staff in attendance: Police Chief, Sean Clayton, Police Lieutenant, Brandon Runyon; Fire Chief, Andrew Bateman; Director of Public Works, Oscar Crosby; Town Attorney, Charlie Barrow; Accounts Payable Manager, Katina Spaulding; Utility Clerk, Renee Holmes; Town Clerk/Zoning Administrator/Town Administrator, Matthew Walker.

   Council Member Larry Ward arrived at 7:45pm

3. **Approval of Amended Meeting Agenda (adding Item 8(d) to the Discussion Agenda)**

   Mayor Williams asked for a motion to approve the amended agenda. **Council Member Drohan made the motion to approve the amended agenda with a second by Council Member Crenshaw. The motion passed unanimously.**

4. **Approval of Minutes from Previous Meeting**:

   Minutes of June 5, 2024
   Minutes of June 26, 2024

   Mayor Williams asked for a motion to approve the meeting minutes of June 5, 2024 and June 26, 2024. **Council Member Crenshaw made the motion to approve the meeting minutes of June 5, 2024 with a second from Council Member Drohan. Council Member Crenshaw made a motion to approve the meeting minutes of June 26, 2024 with a second from Council Member Drohan. The motions passed unanimously.**

5. **Presentation:**

   a) Mayor Williams read the "Know Local-Go Local" business spotlight for August 2024. The businesses recognized in July are: Intracoastal Concrete Construction, Sunrise Healing Arts, Turner Food & Spirits, and Roger's Package Shop.

6. **Finance Report:**

   Ms. Shannon Brett of HBBB reviewed the finance report for June 2024.

7. **Consent Agenda:**

   a) Approval of Engineering Study by Thomas & Hutton

   b) Second Reading and Approval of STR Ordinance Amendment

   c) Second Reading and Approval of Fence Ordinance Amendment

   d) Approval of Standard Repair Agreement for elevator

A motion was made by Council Member Skipper-Greer to approve all items of the consent agenda. Council Member Crenshaw provided the second. The motion passed unanimously.

8. **Discussion Agenda:**

a) Approval of Macceo Drive paving project

A motion was made by Council Member Crenshaw to approve Macceo Drive paving project. Council Member Drohan provided the second. The motion passed unanimously.

b) Approval of PD HVAC replacement

A motion was made by Council Member Drohan to approve PD HVAC replacement. Council Member Crenshaw provided the second. The motion passed unanimously.

c) Town of Thunderbolt investments

A motion was made by Council Member Crenshaw to table this discussion. Council Member Drohan provided the second. The vote to table was unanimous.

d) Planning & Zoning Application – JM & DOC Holdings – Water Tap on Downing Ave.

A motion was made by Council Member Drohan to table this discussion. Council Member Crenshaw provided the second. The vote to table was unanimous.

9. **Department Report** – Written Reports Submitted

by: **Police / Municipal Court / Neighborhood Watch – Sean Clayton, Chief of Police**
Chief Clayton had nothing to add to his report.

Fire –Fire Chief, Andrew Bateman
Chief Bateman had nothing to add to his report.

Public Works Department – Director of Public Works, Oscar Crosby
Director Crosby had nothing to add to his report

Town Clerk – Matthew Walker, Town Clerk
Clerk Walker had nothing further to add to his report.

10. **Legal Report** – Town Attorney, Charlie Barrow

Nothing to report or discuss

11. **Mayor and Council –**

Dangerous/Problematic Intersections – Dr. Drohan

Dr. Drohan stated blind curves and dangerous intersections need to be reviewed for improvements. He recommends 4 way stops and asked Director Crosby to consult with City of Savannah Traffic Engineering for other ways to increase safety at these intersections.

Dilapidated and Neglected properties in Thunderbolt re: health and welfare – Dr. Drohan

Dr. Drohan stated that there are many dilapidated and neglected properties in Town. He read the Code on dilapidated properties and stated something needs to be done to remove the health and safety hazards surrounding these properties. He requested that we consider alternative methods for disabled, elderly, and those living in poverty.

12. **Thunderbolt Museum**

Anna Maria Thomas discussed the Flea Markets will start back in September. The museum is taking donations for items in the museum store. She stated she will need help for the flea markets. She also stated some historical items were donated to the museum that allowed the museum to create a "history wall" for visitors to view.

13. **Executive Session-**

Council Member Crenshaw made a motion at 7:50 pm to leave regular session to enter executive session to discuss Personnel, Property, or Litigation. Council Member Drohan seconded. The motion passed unanimously.

Council Member Crenshaw made a motion at 8:37 pm to leave executive session to return to regular session. Council Member Drohan seconded. The motion passed unanimously.

Mayor Williams announced that Matthew Walker has been named the new Town Administrator for the Town of Thunderbolt

Mayor Williams asked for a motion to adjourn the meeting. **Council Member Ward made the motion with a second from Council Member Crenshaw. The motion passed unanimously.**

14. **Adjournment:**

The meeting adjourned at 8:38 pm.

Dana Williams, Mayor

Matthew D. Walker, Town Clerk

AFFIDAVIT

Personally appeared before the undersigned attesting officer, duly authorized to administer oaths, **Mayor, Dana Williams,** who, after being duly sworn, deposes and on oath states the following:

(1) I was the presiding officer of a meeting of the **Town of Thunderbolt** City Council held on the **10th** day **of July, 2024.**

(2) That it is my understanding that O.C.G.A. 50-14-4 (b) provides as follows:

> *When any meeting of an agency is closed to the public pursuant to subsection (a) of this Code Section the chairperson or other person presiding over such meeting shall execute and file with the official minutes of the meeting a notarized affidavit stating under oath that the subject matter of the meeting or the closed portion thereof was devoted to matters within the exceptions provided by law and identifying the specific relevant exception.*

(3) The subject matter of the closed meeting or closed portion of the meeting held on the **10th** day of **July, 2024** which was closed for the purpose of discussing Real Estate, *Personnel and/or Legal* Matters was devoted to matters within those exceptions as provided by law.

(4) This affidavit is being executed for the purpose of complying with the mandate of O.C.G.A. 50-14-4 (b) that such an affidavit be executed.

This **10th** day of **July, 2024.**

Mayor, Dana Williams

Council Members

Sworn to and subscribed before me
this 10th day of **July, 2024.**

Notary Public

SIGN IN SHEET

MEETING: Town Council **MEETING DATE:** July 10, 2024

NAME:	ADDRESS:
Sue DeRosa	3215 ~~Burdac~~ Bonnan Drive
Joan Hays	2801 Hayes Ave.
Meredith Allen	3220 Fallignant Ave.
Jan Yarbrough	24 Bonaventure.
JoAnne Dickerson	3204 Grass St.
Bill Seward	18 Bonaventure
Catherine Clements	3224 Cedar St Thunderbolt, Ga 31404